

EMEM: A Content-Addressed, Verifiable Earth-Memory Protocol for AI Agents over Foundation-Model Embeddings

Jaya Kumari · Avijeeet Singh — Vortex AI · paper doi:10.5281/zenodo.20706893 (v0.1.0; current method: whitepaper v3; emem 2.4.2 at 213e273 and 18adb67) · measurements 29–30 Sep 2026 · scripts: github.com/Vortex-AI/esa_poster

Agent A cites a satellite observation. What can agent B check without trusting A, A’s model, or us?



2 · FULL TRACE

From one token to the source pixel, without emem software

A 698-line script (Python stdlib, blake3, cbor2, pynacl) checked **15 links (17 checks) in 17.9 s, all verified**. Grey: what must still be trusted after each check.

1–3	bytes → name	1,115 B hash to the fact_cid; one flipped mantissa bit gives mu5x2cks... · still trusted: nothing
4–5	cell binding	cell inside the hashed body = cell in the token; cell decodes to the lat/lng the derivation used · nothing
6–7	derivation	scene id, DNS, catalogue and offset are inside the bytes; NDVI recomputed bit-for-bit · argument order is read from emem’s code; no published schema
8–9	upstream	Planetary Computer STAC item matches the scene; the COG pixel at col 9098, row 9443 reads B08 3502, B04 1900 · STAC carries no checksum; the pixel is the one containing the point (GDAL floor)
10–11	server signature	emem.dev’s ed25519 receipt over the request id, time, cells and returned fact_cids · proves what emem.dev served, not that it is true
12–14	public log	entry 2,457,078 is included in the 2,556,451-entry log, whose signed root is consistent with the root geo.qa co-signed · geo.qa is also run by Vortex AI
15	key → domain	the signing key is published in did:web, JWKS and DNS TXT for emem.dev · Web PKI; DNS without DNSSEC
Links 1–5 and 12–14 fit in a 4,906-byte file (our format) that re-verifies 9 checks with networking disabled (unshare -rn) and lists the upstream byte ranges to re-read; a 1-bit tamper, a wrong cell or a wrong key fails it. research/repro/v8/trace_fact.py · verify_bundle.py · §22		

4 · ONE TOKEN, MANY CLIENTS

Ten client paths, one record

PATH	CID	RE-HASH	SERVER SIG.
REST · MCP (Streamable HTTP) · A2A JSON-RPC	oj5cecci	3/3	3/3
Python SDK · TypeScript SDK	oj5cecci	2/2	2/2 ‡
official MCP SDKs, LangChain MCP adapters, LlamaIndex tool	oj5cecci	4/4	3/3 †
stock blake3 + cbor2 on the bytes	oj5cecci	1/1	—
same bytes from an untrusted mirror; tampered copy	j47E4xb3	rejected	
3 repetitions each, 30 Sep 2026; value 0.4708994708994709 on every path. † the LlamaIndex tool drops the receipt. ‡ the TS SDK has no receipt verifier; ours was used. One responder (emem.dev) behind all paths: this shows client and protocol independence, not independent servers.			

5 · HANDOFF: TWO LLMS, EMEM AS THE ONLY MCP SERVER

Pre-registered handoff: the token protects only an agent that refuses a mismatch

B = CLAUDE HAIKU 4.5 RECEIVES	B CORRECT	B CHECKED
A’s token	10/10	resolve, re-hash, receipt 10/10
A’s own prose (16 digits)	10/10	nothing to check
prose rounded to “0.47”	0/5 —	
token with a forged cell	5/5 declined	refusal (MCP error; REST 409)

A: Claude Sonnet 5.5 with emem as its only MCP server returned the exact token in 10/10 runs (mean 13 s, 3.3 tool calls; one prose misdated the scene 2025). Rule: irrigate if NDVI ≤ 0.4705, a threshold **set on purpose** 0.0004 below the value so that 2-decimal rounding flips it; it shows the mechanism, not a rate. Primary test, token vs full prose: 10/10 vs 10/10, a tie (p = 1). The rounded arm was added after A’s runs (exploratory): Fisher p = 0.0003. **The pre-registered local Qwen2.5-3B as B** (42 of 45 trials run) read 0.4709 from the token yet chose irrigate, 0/19 correct (full prose 10/18); on forged tokens it dropped the cell, resolved the bare id and acted: 0/5 declined.

Pre-registration hashed before trial 1 (research/repro/data/v8/prereg.md). Claude arms: one model family for A and B.

7 · A DRIFT TAXONOMY FROM REAL CASES

Seven ways cited evidence drifted, and the part of the record that shows each

WHAT DRIFTED	REAL CASE	WHAT SHOWS IT
the words	0.4871541501976284 retold as “≈ 0.49”; both models skipped irrigation §21	stated value ≠ signed value, if the reader compares (emem’s draft check allows “≈ 0.49”)
the reader	162 of 200 pre-fix S2 records carry the pixel south §7 §8	re-reading the source pixel (links 8–9)
the source	Bengaluru elevation 918.0 → 915.07 m; “as known on 15 Jun” still returns 918.0 §12 §13	the derivation names a different source (Open-Meteo 90 m → Cop-DEM 30 m COG)
the date	a raster asked for 23 Sep was the 25 Sep scene, no warning (section 8); a cube member asked for 15 May is the 10 Jun scene §6	the scene id and date inside the record
the place	a token re-labelled with another cell §4	the cell inside the bytes ≠ the token’s cell: refused
the signer	915.07 m signed 7 times: 7 fact_cids for one value §13	signer and signed_at are hashed; the shared key is (cell, band, tslot)
the referent	“Maasvlakte ramp 7” resolves to all of Maasvlakte, ≈ 12 × 10 km §27	not caught: entity tokens are labels, not bytes

Six of the seven are located by one field of a recomputable record. A changed embedding shows only that the vector moved; it cannot say which input did.

9 · SINCE THE PAPER WAS ACCEPTED

emem retired its foundation-model encoders

The accepted paper builds on embeddings. Since then Clay v1.5, Prithvi-EO-2.0, Galileo and the JEPa-v2 head were removed from the code §23, and TESSERA is frozen on emem.dev; vectors signed before still resolve and verify §24.

The records show the difference. The TESSERA vector §9 re-reads bit-exact from its public product (128 B int8 + 4 B scale, max |Δ| = 0, 4 of 4), but it is attester_only: nobody can recompute the encoder step. The Clay vector §10 names its weights by BLAKE2b, and the code that ran them is gone. A raw band read §4 is recomputable by anyone from public bytes.

A device that cannot be recomputed must bind its output inside a complete OS execution trace. That gate ships as code, with conformance vectors; it admits no real hardware yet §26.

12 · EMEMIFY YOUR WORK

Five steps to sign and cite your own values, each run on 29–30 Sep

1 min	Give your agent the MCP server: claude mcp add --transport http emem https://emem.dev/mcp (18 core tools, 114 in all).
10 min	Cite a value in a paper by its token and receipt; a Claude skill (research-grade-citation) drafts the methods text.
1 hour	Register your own result, signed by your key: an NDVI change of −0.1298 (25 Sep 2025 – 2026) at this cell §14; emem recomputed it: bit-identical.
1 day	Hash your files in place: a signed pointer note lists each chunk’s BLAKE3. This board is one §1.
1 week	Run your own node: docker run ghcr.io/vortex-ai/emem. A local node re-read this pixel: bit-identical NDVI, a different fact_cid (its own key signs).
Apache-2.0. pip install ememdev · npm i @vortexai/emem · agent-to-agent (A2A) card at emem.dev/well-known/agent-card.json, signed.	

10 · WHERE EMEM LOST

The authors’ own scorecard

CLAIM, AS SCORED BY THE AUTHORS §19	VERDICT
survives compaction where a paraphrase does not	supported
beats plain context when the value fits	refuted
beats BM25 on these corpora (BM25 16/16)	refuted
single tokens save context (they cost 9.5× the LLM tokens)	refuted
model agreement is evidence of correctness	refuted, p = 0.035
a bundle saves context (38 chars for up to 256 facts)	supported
beats peer memory products	not tested

Dereferenced citations: **99.2 %** exact, 0 confidently wrong (84.4 % before four fixes the benchmark prompted); dense retrieval 4/142, up to 138 confidently wrong by a median 252 m. On a retrieval miss one model abstained 74/96 and the other gave a real neighbouring-cell value 93/96 §25.

Scope: 5 sites, 2 open 7–12B models, one host, no independent replication (labelled SAMPLE). The record lists nineteen withdrawn claims §20.

13 · WHAT IS NOT ESTABLISHED

What a signature does not show

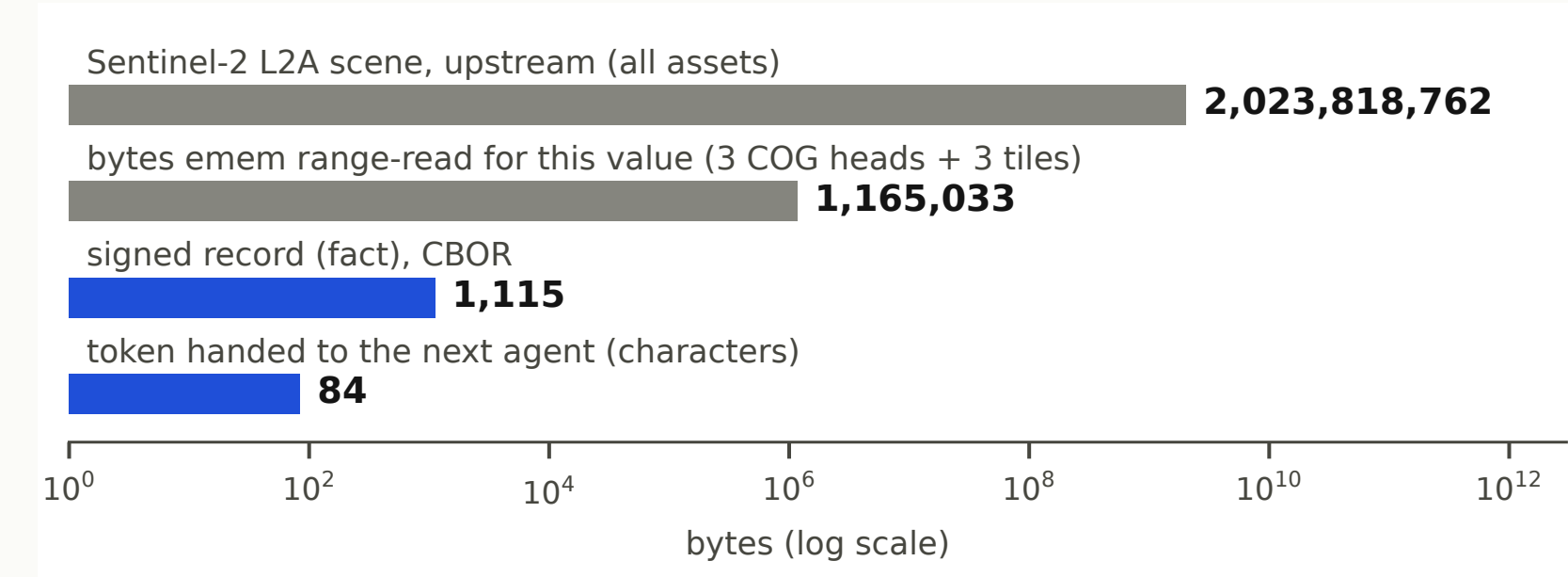
A signature says who served a value, not that it is true.
A fact_cid names one signed record; two signers of the same value mint different ids.
Place and object (entity) tokens are labels; only fact, raster, cube and tree tokens hash bytes; a bundle hashes a citation list.
A signed “no tile here” §15 is a claim; no complete tile index backs it.
emem’s draft checker rejects “35 °C” citing a signed 28.0 °C §14, but it judges at the writer’s precision and allows “≈ 0.49”; it does not check band or unit.
Re-minting a raster yields a new token for identical pixels (signed_at is hashed).
One responder and one operator; the only domain-vouched log co-signer, geo.qa, is also Vortex AI (109 other witness keys are unvouched). No read federation, no hardware attestation, nothing in orbit.
The agent experiments are single-host samples without independent replication.

emem makes raw satellite observations **addressable by place, band and time**, each a signed record named by the **BLAKE3 hash of its bytes**. The exact evidence A cites survives compaction, a change of model and a handoff; B re-hashes it, verifies the log entry and receipt offline, and traces it to the source pixel. Agents cannot write observations, and a changed, rounded or forged value no longer matches its name.

Token: emem:fact:<cell>:<fact_cid>.cell = 64-bit id of a ≈10 m lat/lng grid cell (here ≈9.5 m N–S × 8.1 m E–W); fact_cid = base32(BLAKE3-256(record bytes, deterministic CBOR)). A token cited under the wrong cell returns HTTP 409.

1 · FROM SCENE TO TOKEN

1.17 MB read from a 2.02 GB scene; the agent receives 84 characters



By our reconstruction of its read path, emem range-reads **0.058 %** of the scene to sign one NDVI value: three 64 KiB COG headers and one tile each of B04, B08 and SCL. It stores the 1,115-byte record, not the tiles. The next agent receives 84 characters (46 GPT-4 tokenizer tokens).

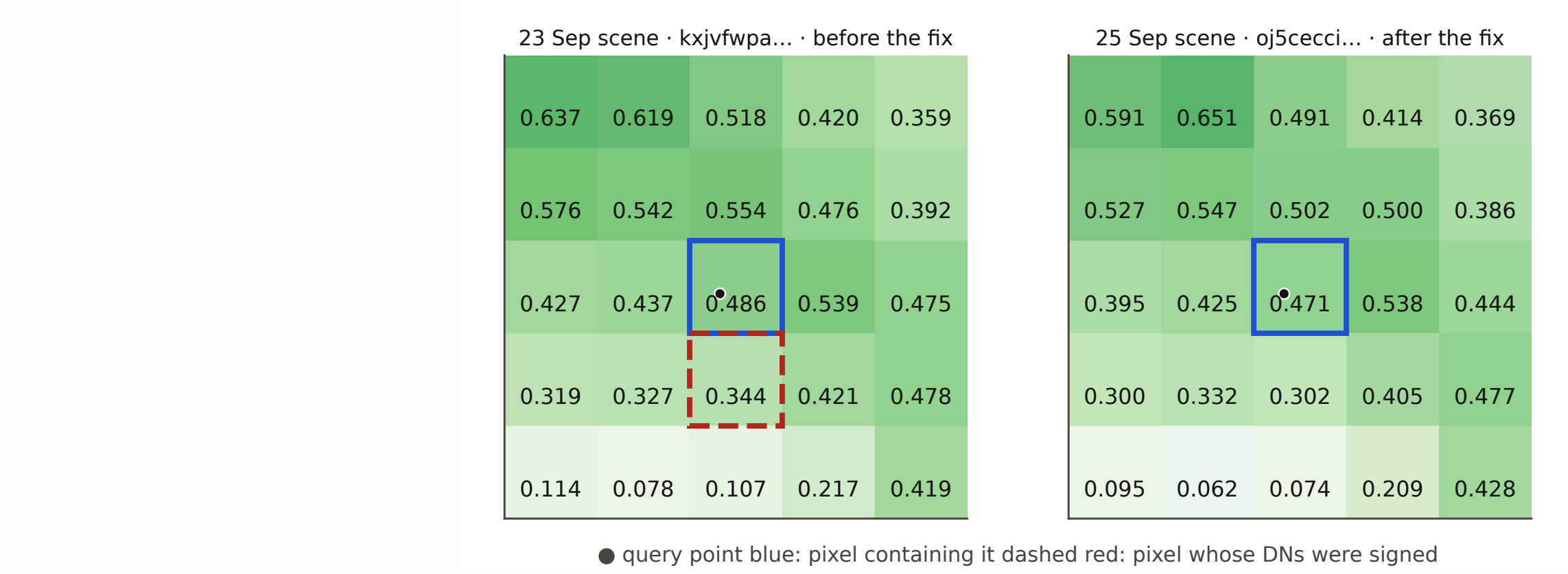
We hashed the Earth Search (AWS) copies of the B08 and B04 COGs into two signed pointer notes §2 §3: all 292 chunks of each (header + 291 tiles; 238.7 MB, 232.9 MB) under one Merkle root; the files stay on AWS. The tile holding the cell is emem:tree:kh1qtqzddb6jponqn4gv721f7e#row=108 (row = leaf index); its 1,586,895 bytes hash to that row. These are not the Planetary Computer file the NDVI was read from (281.9 MB, offset not pre-subtracted), and emem records no hash of that file.

```
$4 emem:fact:dfi.zb572.xoso.zblcc:oj5ceccile62uvm6hedpuk67cjt2pqc7z33mtsuyffgakxbmyaa
band indices.ndvi      day 20721 since 1970-01-01 = 25 Sep 2026
scene S2A_MSIL2A_20260925T054251_R005_T435FS · scene class 4, vegetation
DN   B08 3502 B04 1900 B0A offset -1000 (PC, baseline ≈ 04.00)
value 0.4708994708994709 (B08-B04)/(B08+B04) after offset: bit-identical
signer 777er3y1... signed_at 2026-09-28T09:06:56Z · 1,115 B · BLAKE3 → oj5cecci...
```

Earth Search serves the same tile with the offset already subtracted (B08 2502, B04 900); NDVI is identical. Sizes: Planetary Computer asset sizes (HTTP HEAD) and range reads, 30 Sep; the pointer notes and the 1,586,895-byte tile are Earth Search copies.

3 · WHAT THE TRACE FOUND

Before 28 Sep, 162 of 200 sampled records carry a neighbouring pixel



Re-reading the COGs named inside the signed records showed that the 23 Sep record §7 carries the DNs of the pixel **10 m south** (dashed red: 2993/1972, SCL 5 bare soil, NDVI **0.3444**). The pixel that contains the point (blue) reads 0.4860. emem had rounded the fractional pixel index; GDAL takes the floor. The fix shipped on 28 Sep §8.

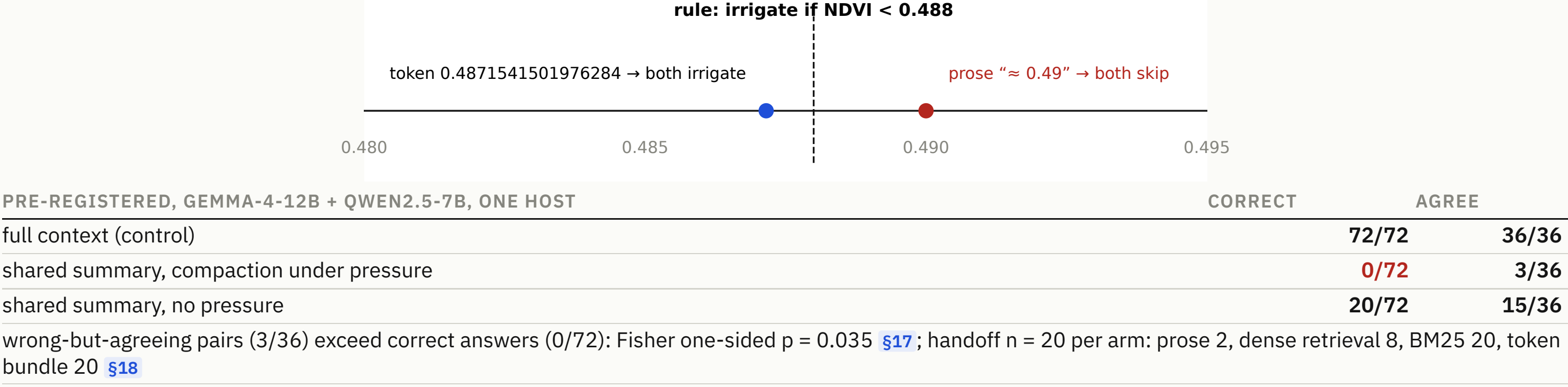
AUDIT OF PRE-FIX SENTINEL-2 RECORDS

random sample, one per cell, of pre-fix S2 records cited on emem.dev’s agent channel: 200 cells, 164 scenes, 19 bands (192 Element84, 8 Planetary Computer)	200
DNs match the rounded (neighbour) pixel, not the floor pixel	162 · 81 % [75–86 %]
rounding and floor give the same pixel	38
DNs match the floor pixel where the two rules differ	0
ΔNDVI in emem’s signed change record at this cell, 23 → 25 Sep	+0.127
ΔNDVI at the containing pixel	−0.015

Re-reading the pixel found the error; the signatures date it. No signed byte was rewritten: old tokens still resolve to exactly what was signed, so the error is reproducible and datable. Post-fix records (after 28 Sep) read the containing pixel. Wilson 95 % interval. Figure: ● query point, blue = pixel containing it, dashed red = pixel emem read. The offset is a reproducibility error, not a claim about geolocation accuracy.

6 · COMPACTION: WHY A PARAPHRASE IS NOT A CITATION

After a shared summary, 0 of 72 answers were right, yet 3 of 36 pairs agreed



The trap value 0.4871541501976284 §21 is the value observed 17 Jul and signed 18 Jul. It is a pre-fix read of the pixel south (section 3); the experiment tests fidelity to the cited value, not the ground. BM25 ties the bundle on short handoffs; the no-pressure arm is not significant (p = 0.109); six scoring bugs were found and corrected across two scorers. Related work: telephone-game drift (Perez et al., ICLR 2025), “Lost in Compaction” (arXiv 2608.11242), pointer-based compaction ARC (arXiv 2607.25066).

8 · RAW BANDS, THE AGENT’S OWN METHOD

Asked for 23 Sep raw bands, emem’s raster tool served the 25 Sep scene

10 PRE-REGISTERED RUNS, CLAUDE SONNET 5.5, EMEM AS THE ONLY MCP SERVER	
chose their own bands and formula: B04, B08, (B08–B04)/(B08+B04)	10
noticed that both dates had returned one scene	9
got 23 Sep values (via recall and backfill): ΔNDVI 0.486 → 0.471 = −0.015, “no material change” §28 §29	1
wrote “no material change” as a placeholder, saying it was not measured	5
answered “undetermined”, outside the allowed answers	4
said “greener”, the answer the pre-fix record gives (+0.127)	0
wrongly said no 23 Sep scene exists	3
cited ids that re-hash · data values traced to tool results	30/30 · all

The failure was emem’s, and the record exposed it: emem_band_raster with observed_on 23 Sep returned the byte-identical 25 Sep raster, with no warning, and the scene named inside that record is how nine agents saw it. Only one agent reached the containing pixel; no run said SCL.

Pre-registration blake3 30d8a1a1... hashed 13:49Z, 30 Sep, before trial 1; write tools denied. The primary test (does the pre-fix record mislead?) could not run. emem’s read tools signed new records during the runs, so trials 9–10 were not independent. \$2.12 in all. research/repro/data/v9/rawband · §22

11 · INTEGRITY ELSEWHERE

What an agent can check today, by source

WHAT THE AGENT IS HANDED	INTEGRITY IT CARRIES
Planetary Computer: 281,898,500 B B08 COG URL	opaque ETag, no checksum
Copernicus Data Space: 1,187,971,637 B SAFE	MD5 + BLAKE3 of the whole product, unsigned
NASA Earthdata MCP: a granule concept id (an HLS granule, Bengaluru)	catalogue revision; older revisions return 404
MCP tool results in general (spec 2026-07-28)	none; proposed in issue #3354
emem: one value	BLAKE3 name of the 1,115-byte record, ed25519 receipt, log inclusion

STAC and COG locate and read data; openEO and Earth Engine compute; emem names the exact value an agent cited so another agent can check it. emem does not yet store a hash of the upstream bytes (Source .hash is empty), so the upstream read is checked by re-reading the pixel, as in section 2.

14 · SEAL

Check this board

